MOUNTAIN REVIEW

OFFICIAL NEWSLETTER OF THE MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION

Volume VI | Issue IV | Fall 2016

Page 3
Immigrant House restoration update!



Page 4
The history of Club Estrella, our November event partner

Page 6
Find out how you can help create MVHA's first-ever Dia de los Muertos altar!



Celebrating Mtn. View's Mexican Heritage



Members of the Castro family in front of their home, Villa Francesca; currently the location of Rengstorff Park.

Since its founding, Mountain View has been home to many diverse communities made up of people from all corners of the globe. One of the most deeply rooted is the Mexican community, with a history stretching back to the era of Mexican ranchos, when the Castro family owned most of what is now Mountain View and Sunnyvale and lived near what is now Rengstorff Park.

Early November is a time when Mexican communities remember and honor their ancestors through ***Dia de los Muertos*** (Day of the Dead) traditions. The MVHA is excited to partner with **Club Estrella**—a Mexican American social club founded in Mountain View in 1948—to turn our November 6 membership meeting into Mountain View's first Dia de los Muertos celebration.

The event will feature presentations on the city's Mexican heritage, live mariachi music, and more! See details on pages 5 and 6!

MOUNTAIN REVIEW

This newsletter is published four times a year by the
MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION
P.O. Box 252, Mountain View, CA 94042
www.mountainviewhistorical.org

BOARD MEMBERS & CHAIRS

President: Candace Bowers
Vice-President: **Vacant**
Secretary: Jamil Shaikh
Treasurer: John Figueroa
Past President: Nick Galiotto
Historical Data: Eugene Sharp
Membership: June Casey
Newsletter Editor: Nick Perry
Ways & Means: Richard Espinosa
Director-at-Large: Lisa Roquero Garcia
Director-at-Large: **Vacant**
Hospitality: Helene Hughes
Programs: **Vacant**
Publicity: Marina Marinovich

In Memoriam

Olof Lennart Ahlkvist
November 17, 1924–May 24, 2016

Dominic J. Marchetti
February 17, 1913–December 27, 2015

News & Notes





Our wonderful BBQ volunteers hard at work! Kat Blankeheimer (left) had the important task of making sure there were enough super fries (AKA Tater Tots) for everyone, while Cliff Del Carlo (right) and family manned the grill. Thank you to all our volunteers!

President's Message

By Candace Bowers
MVHA President

Greetings, MVHA members—

It was good to see so many of you at our annual summer BBQ at the historic Adobe. As usual, we had a nice mix of long-time residents who love to share their memories and newcomers who want to learn more about their adopted city. We were treated to a screening of the documentary "The Legacy of Arrow Development," which tells the story of a truly innovative Mountain View company that gave us many of our favorite and world-famous amusement park rides. Thank you Nicholas, Kimberly, Kris and Robert for sharing your film with us. And thank you to our members who pitched in to help us set up the room; prepare and serve our (authentically re-created) Parisian burgers; and clean up at the end of the event—Especially the Del Carlo and Blankenheimer families! Our Board members always work hard to bring you these programs, but we couldn't do it without your help.

And if you would like to become more involved in the Association, we are looking for members to join our Board in 2017. With several current Board members retiring or moving into other positions, the positions of Vice President and Secretary will soon be vacant. Please consider this opportunity to play a vital (and fun) role in your Association. You don't need prior experience; perhaps this will be your first time on the board of any organization. The requirements? Enthusiasm for Mountain View and its history; attendance at our quarterly Board meetings, held in the History Center at the Library; and collaboration on some, but not always all, of our group events. Interested? Send us an email, or phone the History Center at (650) 903-6890.

Our November event promises something new and different (while deeply "Mountain View"): the food, the entertainment, the special guest, and the chance for YOU to contribute in a unique way.

History Center Update

By Candace Bowers
MVHA President

It's always exciting to receive a phone call out of the blue that begins, "Hello, my name is _____ Stierlin" or "This is _____ Castro." So when the History Center was contacted recently by a member of the Whisman family, asking whether we'd be interested in some of their family photos, we were thrilled to say yes. They kindly sent us several items of family memorabilia for our collection.

We've also received an anonymous donation of photographs that show the ground-breaking and construction of Eagle Park.

Immigrant House Update

By Marina Marinovich *Publicity Chair* & Hannah Hasbun

We are pleased to announce that after great collaboration between the City of Mountain View and Santa Clara County and much community effort, Mountain View's historic Immigrant House has settled into its new home. From its original location on Bryant Street, now the site of a new office building, and after a three-year hiatus in storage at the Municipal Operations Center, the 400-square-foot cottage was safely relocated 2.5 miles away to the new Heritage Park site at 771 N. Rengstorff Ave on August 8. The trip went smoothly thanks to extensive caution and sophisticated methods used to transport it in one piece.

The city has hired an architect experienced with historic structures to ensure the building meets the rehabilitation standards set by the Secretary of the Interior. Amazingly, upon removing the dry wall in the restoration process, six layers of wallpaper possibly dating back to the 1860s were discovered. The beautifully unique wallpaper offers a glimpse of the original decor of the houses' parlor and kitchen. It was determined that the first layer was applied when the house was first built.

Additionally, when the sheetrock in the kitchen was removed, long-forgotten artifacts were uncovered. Among these artifacts was an old Dixie ice cream cup lid, such as one might find on an ice cream packed in a school lunch with a wooden spoon inside. In the 1940s, movie stars were printed on the insides of these lids and were collected with incentives like a free poster, similar to the way baseball cards are collected. The found lid features a headshot of Roy Rogers, dating it to around 1943. The going theory is that children living in the house saved the lids. This leads us to believe that at some point Immigrant House may have acted as additional storage for the main house on the corner.

Senior Project Manager Rey Rodriguez agreed that the wallpaper unveiling was fascinating. Even more interesting "has been the history uncovered on the people who lived in the house," he mused. "All of that is based on the census that I've looked at over the years, and some sleuthing." He and Candace Bowers, our president and librarian of the history room at the Mountain View Library, have been busy researching the house throughout the project.

Financial Report

By John Figueroa
Treasurer

Checking Account Balance as of 6/8/16: $13,083.91
- Income: $261.18
- Expenses: $2,034.42

Checking Account Balance as of 8/31/16: $11,310.67

Certificates of Deposit Balance as of 3/9/16: $71,867.07
Certificates of Deposit Balance as of 8/31/16: $71,893.83



Immigrant House undergoing restoration (Courtesy Rey Rodriguez)

Heritage Park, which will be passive-use, is set to open in December and will feature the 1880s-era Immigrant House as its central focus, accompanied by community gardens, paths, a beehive area and an 80-year-old windmill. The park will stand as a tribute to Mountain View's agricultural origins and provide a glimpse into daily life of the 19th century. Even further, it will reveal insights into immigrant involvement in the region's agrarian past.

With the historical redwood building scheduled for demolition, the Friends of Immigrant House raised the funds for its salvation and restoration including a $50,000 contribution each from Google and Santa Clara County. With Heritage Park preparing to open and the renovation of Immigrant House well under way, these are exciting times for residents and descendants of immigrants who once lived in this house. One such local (yours truly) is Mary Kay "Marina" Marinovich, of Croatian heritage.

I think I can now tell my dad I helped move the little house. That the house may now thrive in an environment suited to its original purpose is a monumental blessing for immigrants and Mountain View locals of the past, present and future alike.

History of Club Estrella



Club Estrella members gather on Washington Street for a parade c. 1950

Club Estrella was founded in February 1948 by a group of dynamic women who were sponsored by St. Joseph's Catholic Church in Mountain View. The club's purpose was to promote Mexican-American culture in a social atmosphere as well as to assist the poor and needy. Their mentor through the church was Father Donald McDonnell who had an excellent rapport with the women as he spoke Spanish and assimilated easily into their culture. Father McDonnell also assisted in sponsoring the club's own credit union, the Guadalupe Federal Credit Union, named for the Virgen of Guadalupe.

The name Club Estrella literally translated from Spanish to English means "Star Club," but how the club got its name is a source of discussion that goes on within the members to this day. One version has it that when the club's founders were wondering what to call their club, one woman spoke of a club with the name "Club Estrella" in her hometown in New Mexico. The first president of Club Estrella was Mrs. Carmen Sias (late great-grandmother of MVHA Board Members Lisa Garcia and Nick Perry). Most of the club's founding members lived on or near Washington Street in Mountain View, which at that time was known as the "Mexican Colony" of Mountain View.

In the beginning, celebrations were held in the church hall during the Feast of the Virgen de Guadalupe. Club Estrella family members annually portrayed the Pageant of the Virgen de Guadalupe apparition. Besides the pageant, typical Mexican dances were portrayed, directed by Mrs. Rose Cervantes as well as representation from other dance groups. Mexican food booths were also installed to the delight of all attending the festivities. Club Estrella also participated in the 1950 California Centennial celebration held in Mountain View and was represented in Cinco de Mayo and Deis y Seis de Septembre (Mexican Independence Day) parades.

Fe, Amistad y Progresso
FAITH, FRIENDSHIP, & PROGRESS

In it early years, Club Estrella was relatively choosy about who could belong, and it wasn't until the fifties that husbands of the members were allowed to join. The men had always helped with the club's events. For over two decades, a "Couples Only" rule applied, but today, Club Estrella by-laws allow single women and men to join the club. Club Estrella currently has members throughout Santa Clara County and is actively recruiting new members. The Club gained nonprofit status in 1965 with the help of Joe Perez , a club member who went on to become the first Mexican-American council member and mayor of Mountain View. The club was incorporated in 1992; its motto is *Fe, Amistad y Progresso* which means, Faith, Friendship and Progress.

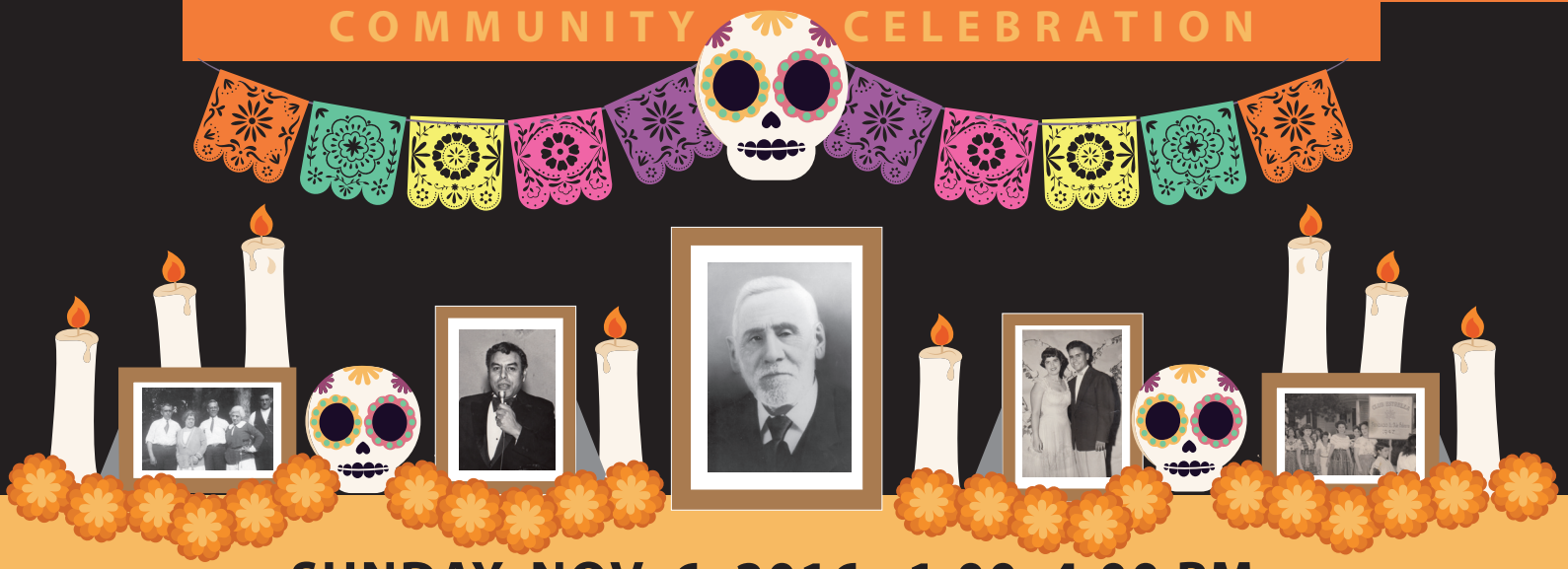
Club Estrella continues to follow the traditions of its founders with pride by offering the community the richness of its Mexican-American culture. They sponsor approximately five dances annually and various events like a Mexican Tardeada (fiesta), Reno trips and picnics. The Club also continues to assist people who are in need of help. Club Estrella supports other service organizations with donations and started a scholarship fund in 1992 that grants annual scholarships to deserving high school graduates going on to higher learning. Over 160 Club Estrella scholarships have been awarded, and the Club remains committed to promoting higher education within the Santa Clara County Latino community.

For more information on Club Estrella and its scholarship program, visit **www.estrellaclub.com.**

Fall Event

Mountain View Dia de los Muertos

COMMUNITY CELEBRATION



SUNDAY, NOV. 6, 2016, 1:00–4:00 PM

THE HISTORIC ADOBE BUILDING, 157 MOFFETT BLVD. MTN. VIEW

HOSTED BY:

MVHA
MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION

IN PARTNERSHIP WITH:

CLUB ESTRELLA FOUNDED 1948

In Mexico the first two days of November are celebrated as ***Dia de los Muertos (Day of the Dead)***. During this special time of year, families and friends gather to remember those who have passed away. The celebration has ancient roots, stretching back to the time of the Aztecs. In the United States, Dia de los Muertos has become increasingly popular with people of many cultural backgrounds.

On Sunday, November 6 the **Mtn. View Historical Association** is partnering with **Club Estrella**—a Mexican-American social club founded in Mtn. View in 1948—to bring the first Dia de los Muertos celebration to Mtn. View. This **FREE** event will take place at the historic Adobe Building and will feature special presentations on Mtn. View's Mexican heritage, including a presentation by **Crisanto Castro**—a descendent of the Castro family for which Castro street was named—and a live performance by Northern California's premier mariachi band, **Mariachi Tapatio** of San Jose! The event will also serve as the MVHA's Fall 2016 membership meeting where we will elect our 2017-18 Board.

Attendees of all cultures are invited to participate by sharing photos of their ancestors to be included in a special Mtn. View-themed **Dia de los Muertos altar.** See page 6 for more info.

We hope you will join us for this very special celebration!

FEATURING:

MARIACHI TAPATIO

FREE EVENT - RSVP BY VISITING WWW.MVHISTORY.EVENTBRITE.COM

Dia de los Muertos Altar

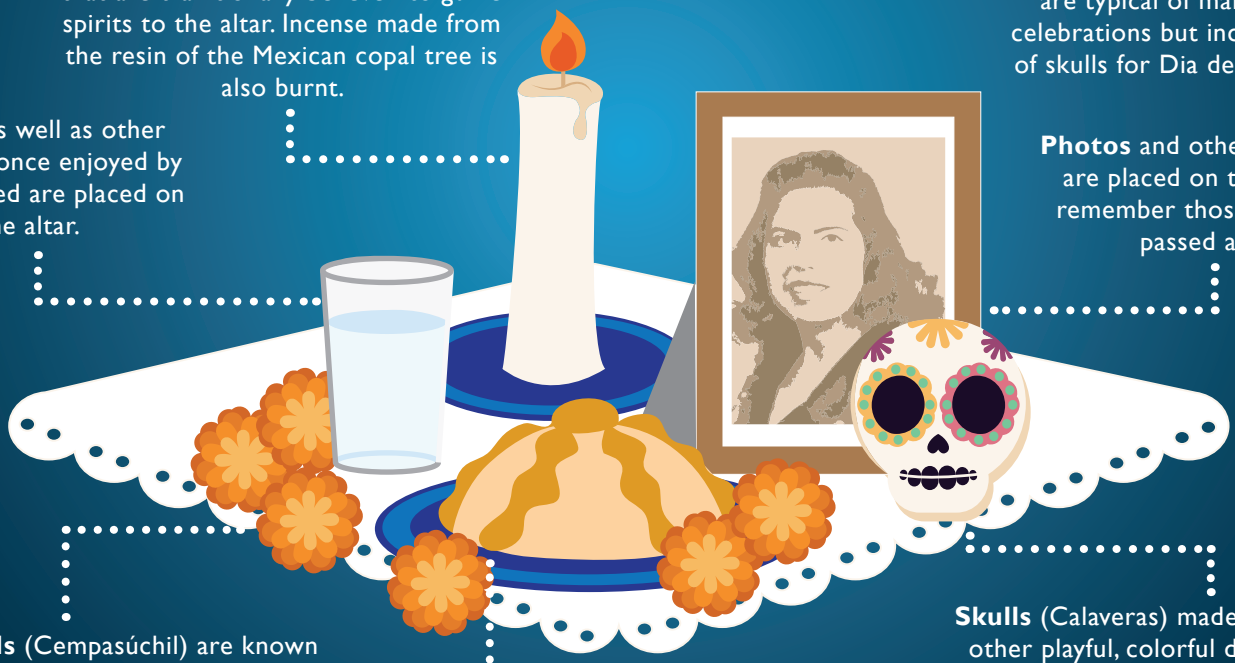
Symbols & Traditions

Candles are symbols of light and hope that are traditionally believed to guide spirits to the altar. Incense made from the resin of the Mexican copal tree is also burnt.

Paper Banners (Papel Picado) represent the element of wind, are typical of many Mexican celebrations but include symbols of skulls for Dia de los Muertos.

Water as well as other beverages once enjoyed by the departed are placed on the altar.

Photos and other mementos are placed on the altar to remember those who have passed away.



Marigolds (Cempasúchil) are known as the flowers of the dead in Mexico, where it is traditionally believed their aroma guides spirits back to visit their families on Dia de los Muertos.

Food, including Pan de Muerto (Bread of the Dead). It's traditionally believed that spirits of the departed are nourished by the spirit of food left on the altar.

Skulls (Calaveras) made of sugar and other playful, colorful depictions of skeletons represent the circle of life and death.

An important part of Dia de los Muertos celebrations is building an altar or "ofrenda" (offering) to remember and honor loved ones who have passed away. Although traditions vary by region, altars in Mexico are typically assembled and displayed in family homes and at cemeteries.

In the United States, a growing number of cities have begun Dia de los Muertos celebrations. A "Festival of Altars" has been taking place at Garfield Park in the Mission District of San Francisco since the 1970s. Traditional elements of a Dia de los Muertos altar are described in the graphic above.

For our Dia de los Muertos Celebration, the MVHA will assemble an altar in the Mtn. View History Center on the second floor of the library on Sunday, October 30 at 1:00 p.m. The altar will be relocated to the Adobe Building for our event on November 6.

We invite members to bring photos of any departed loved ones to display on the altar! Bring your photos to the History Center on October 30 or to our event on November 6. You can also email us your photos in advance and we will print and display them on the altar. Email the photo, the name of the person(s) in the image, and blurb on any special connection they had to Mtn. View to: **newsletter@mountainviewhistorical.org.**

Membership + BBQ Photos!

Membership Report

By June Casey, *Membership Chair* & Lisa Garcia *Director-at-Large*

Membership as of September 27, 2016

Honored Members	2
Life Members	114
Family Members	86
Single Members	124
TOTAL MEMBERSHIP	**326**

New Members: Tori Ann Atwell, Thida Cornes, James Zesch and Judy Zellers

Editors Note: *We forgot to welcome our new Family Members in our Summer newsletter, so a belated welcome to the following members:* ***Mike and Marie Casey, Harry and Nancy Wilson, Lydia Sherrill, Richard and Sharon Horton, and Valda C. Tormey!***

A warm welcome to all our new members!



Lisa Garcia (Director-at-Large) & June Casey (Membership Chair) at the BBQ check-In table.



Vice Mayor Ken Rosenberg enjoys a Parisian Burger with Emily Ramos, Lucas Ramirez & Councilmember Chris Clark

Volunteer Opportunities

The MVHA welcomes members interested in lending their time and talent. Below are some immediate needs:

Event Tabling: Greet the public at MVHA's table at upcoming events.

History Center: Help us share our historic archives with the public at the library.

Board Positions: We have immediate openings to fill on our Board! Our Board meets only four times a year, so the time commitment is small but the impact is huge! We will gladly answer any questions you may have about membership, joining the Board, or volunteering. Email questions to info@mountainviewhistorical.org or leave us a voicemail at (650) 903-6890.



Ellen Kamei, Lisa Matichak & Margaret Abe-Koga



Nick Perry (Newsletter Editor), Joe Peltier & their godson Javi Cupa.



Renato & Josephine Del Carlo, our beverage booth volunteers! Thank you!

MVHA MEMBERSHIP FORM

The MVHA welcomes new members! By becoming a member, you are making a special investment in our mission to preserve and share Mtn. View history with the community, conserve priceless archival materials at the History Center, and hold memorable public events throughout the year. Please support the MVHA, and join us today!

- ☐ New Membership
- ☐ Membership Renewal
- ☐ Single Membership: *$15/year*
- ☐ Family Membership: *$25/year*
- ☐ Life Membership *$200*
- ☐ *I'm interested in volunteer opportunities*

Name: _____

Street Address: _____

City: _____

State: _____ Zip Code: _____

Telephone: _____

Email: _____

Please make checks payable to:
Mtn. View Historical Association

Mail this form to:
Mtn. View Historical Association
P.O. Box 252
Mtn. View CA 94042

Newsletter Subscription Preference

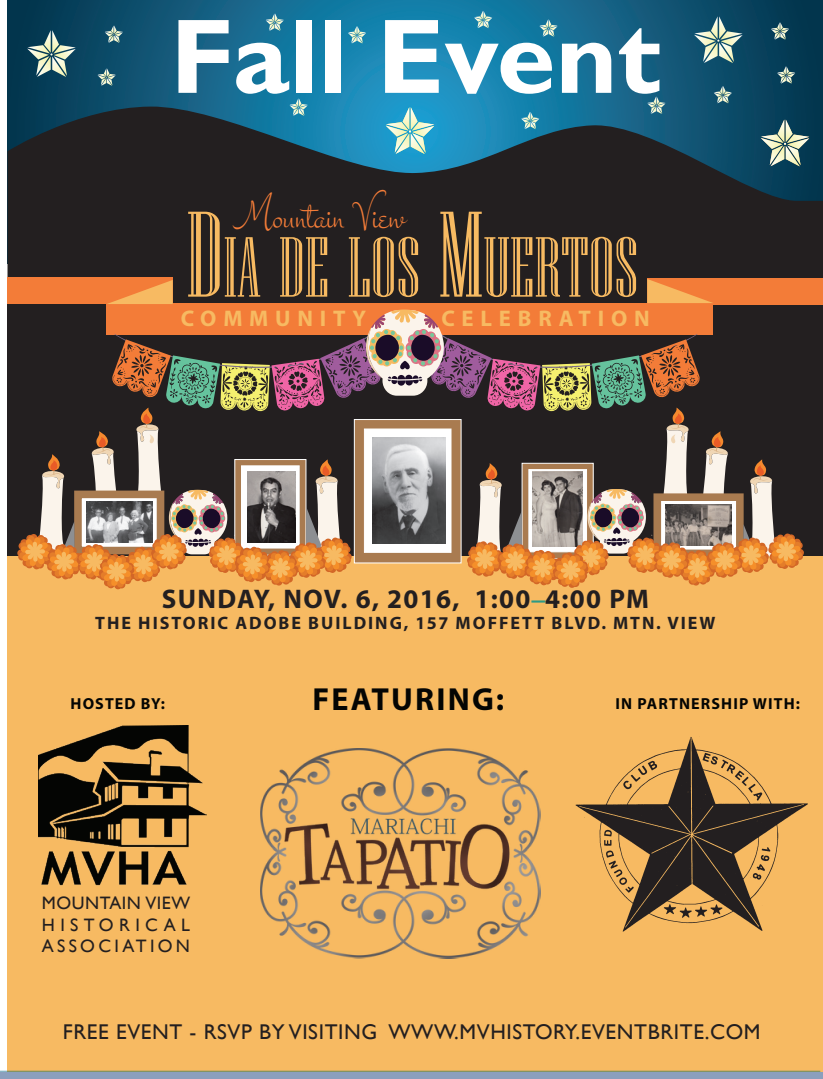
☐ Email (Full color, save paper!) ☐ Mail (Black & White)

FALL / WINTER

November 6
Sunday, 1:00–4:00 p.m.
MVHA Fall Event & Meeting
The Adobe Building–157 Moffett Blvd.
See details on Pages 5-6

December 14
Wednesday, 6:30–8:00 p.m.
MVHA Board Meeting
M.V. Library History Center–585 Franklin St.
Members interested in volunteering for Board positions and future MVHA events/projects are encouraged to attend!

January 29
Sunday, 1:00–3:00 p.m.
MVHA Winter Event & Meeting
Adobe Building–157 Moffett Blvd.
Details in our Winter Newsletter!



EST. 1954
MOUNTAIN REVIEW
MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION
P.O. Box 252
Mountain View, CA 94042
WEB: www.mountainviewhistorical.org
EMAIL: mvha.newsletter@gmail.com

FIRST-CLASS MAIL

Join the conversation online!
www.facebook.com/MVHistory
www.twitter.com/MtnViewHistory

Save a tree and see the newsletter in:
Full Color
E-mail **newsletter@mountainviewhistorical.com**
to receive your newsletter as an Adobe PDF.